

पेंशन निधि विनियामक और विकास प्राधिकरण

PENSION FUND REGULATORY AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY



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Unified Pension Scheme

[Home](#) [Schemes](#) [Unified Pension Sc...](#)

About

The Unified Pension Scheme (UPS) is a pension scheme introduced by the Government of India, effective 1st April 2025, as an option under the National Pension System (NPS) for Central Government employees. It is designed to provide assured, inflation-indexed, and adequate retirement benefits, addressing concerns of longevity protection and pension predictability.



UPS operates within the existing NPS architecture regulated by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) and is applicable to both serving and retired employees under specific conditions.

Eligibility

UPS is available to:

- Existing Central Government Employees under NPS as on 01.04.2025.
- New Recruits joining Central Government service on or after 01.04.2025.
- Retired NPS Subscribers who superannuated or retired on or before 31.03.2025, provided:
 - Minimum 10 years of qualifying service.
 - Retirement under FR 56(i) (not as a penalty)

Timelines for Option Exercise:

- Retirement under FR 56(j) (not as a penalty).
- Legally wedded spouse as on date of retirement, in case of subscriber's demise.
- Existing employees (as on 01.04.2025)/retirees (upto 31.03.2025): Option has to be exercised by 30th November 2025, or within such extended timelines if any, allowed by the Central Government.
- New recruits: Within 30 days of joining

Features of UPS

Contribution Structure

- Employee Contribution: 10% of Basic Pay + Dearness Allowance (DA).
- Government Contribution: Matching 10% (from payroll system).
- Additional Government Contribution: An estimated 8.5% of Basic Pay + DA to a Pool Corpus.

Corpus Composition

- Individual Corpus (IC): Accumulated contributions of employee and matching government share.
- Benchmark Corpus (BC): Notional corpus computed using default investment pattern, regular and timely contributions and without any partial withdrawal & voluntary corpus.

Investment Options

- Default Pattern (auto-assigned if no choice made).
- 100% Government Securities (Scheme G).
- Life Cycle Funds:
 - Life Cycle 25 – Low (5E/55Y) (Equity allocation 25% upto 35 years of age, falling to 5% at 55+)
 - Life Cycle 50 – Moderate (10E/55Y) (Equity allocation 50% upto 35 years of age, falling to 10% at 55+)
- Change Frequency:
 - Pension Fund: Once per Financial Year.
 - Investment Pattern: Twice per Financial Year.

Benefits under UPS

Assured Payout, at the rate of 50% of last 12 monthly average basic pay, immediately prior to superannuation. Assured payout is payable after a minimum 25 years of qualifying service. In case of lesser qualifying service period, proportionate payout would be admissible.

Minimum Guaranteed Payout: ₹10,000/month (after 10 years of service).

Proportionate payout: Between 10 and 25 years of service.

Final Withdrawal: Up to 60% of IC or BC, whichever is lower. Reduces assured payout proportionately. Option to replenish shortfall to restore full payout.

Lump Sum Payment: ₹ $(1/10) \times (\text{Last Drawn Basic Pay} + \text{DA})$ for every completed 6 months of qualifying service. Payable on superannuation, voluntary retirement, or retirement under FR 56(j).

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Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority

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